Ollscoil Teicneolaíochta an Oirdheiscirt
South East Technological University

Department of Computing
CARLOW

B.Sc. in Interactive Digital Art and Design

Academic Year 2025 / 2026

Project Diary & Notebook

Name: Yuliia Antonova

Student ID: C00301432

Supervisor: Anita Dice

Project Title: Short Character Stories for Social Media Platforms

This is an important Document - Do not lose it!

Schedule of Dates and Project Deliverables

Project Schedule 25/26

Month	Week	Week Starting	Date	Description	Deliverable	Deliverable Number
January	1	12-Jan	12-Jan	Kick Off Meeting		
			16-Jan	Project Proposal	submit on Black Board	
			19-Jan	Supervisor Allocation	supervisor / student meeting	
	2	26-Jan	26-Jan	Submission	**Submission of Deliverable 1**	1
	3	26-Jan		weekly supervisor/student meeting		
February	4	2-Feb		PROGRESS REPORT	Interim Presentation	
	5	9-Feb		weekly supervisor/student meeting		
		READING WEEK		unsupervised project work		
	6	23-Feb		weekly supervisor/student meeting	**Submission of Deliverable 2**	2
March	7	2-Mar		weekly supervisor/student meeting		
	8	9-Mar		PROGRESS REPORT	Interim Presentation	
	9	16-Mar		weekly supervisor/student meeting		
April	10	23-Mar		weekly supervisor/student meeting		
		EASTER BREAK		unsupervised project work		3
	11	13-Apr		weekly supervisor/student meeting	**Submission of Deliverable 3**	
	12	21-Apr		Delivery Week	Final Submission of All Deliverables, project report, source files, diary, etc.	

IDAD Project Documents

Proposal: 1 page

Specification of the type of web presence to be modelled. Background of the proposed Business environment / application.
Proposal should include a description of the entity intended to model as well as a reason (or reasons) for how the entity would benefit from having a web presence.

Planning & Research document: (5 marks)

Project plan & timeline
Platform choice, software stack choice, description existing system, similar existing sites, Proposed outline site map (basic)

Project Requirements & Specification: (10 marks)

Overview of Business

Project Objectives, User roles,
Functional requirements of each user:
Features & functional specification for each user: List features & purpose of features

Design & Storyboard: (10 marks)

Content plan and flow, design specifications, Storyboard

Progress Presentation: (10 marks)

Brief Description of Project, work done so far, work you still have to do, Technology Options/Discussion, Potential Issues/Challenges

Project Final Report: (15 marks)

Description of Submitted Project, Description of Conformance to Specification and Design, Description of Learning, Scrum experience; Full Review of Project

Technical document: Admin & Setup Guide (10 marks)

Detailed instructions on how to **install**, **set-up**, **configure** and **use** the system.

Project Management: Stand Up Meetings and Diary (10 marks)

Evidence that the project process was executed effectively and effeciently through all the stages through to final production.

Full rubric will be available in a separate document.

PROJECT DOCUMENTATION STANDARDS

All documents submitted as part of the project are to be word processed and submitted on-line. Upload links will be provided at the relevant deliverable dates.

The format of each document must conform to this specification:

- Title Page: including your project title, name, login-id, supervisor's name, and date of submission.
- Table of Contents.
- Introduction to the report
- Page numbering (in a footer) is required on all pages *except* the title page.
- References and a bibliography are required for all material sourced from elsewhere (including printed works and material from the Internet). The format of references is to conform to the published standards for the *Department of Computing*.

Be sure to spell-check your documents *before* submission.

Work submitted for assessment which does not include this declaration will not be assessed.

DECLARATION

*I declare that all material in this submission e.g. thesis/essay/project/assignment is entirely my/our own work except where duly acknowledged.

*I have cited the sources of all quotations, paraphrases, summaries of information, tables, diagrams or other material; including software and other electronic media in which intellectual property rights may reside.

*I have provided a complete bibliography of all works and sources used in the preparation of this submission.

* I have not used Artificial Intelligence to create any of my work, where AI has been used and been cited and all prompts used have been added to an appendix in my final deliverable.

*I understand that failure to comply with the Institute's regulations governing plagiarism constitutes a serious offence.

Student Name: (Printed) Yuliia Antonova

Student Number: C00301432

Signature:

Date: April 2026

Please note:

The Institute regulations on plagiarism are set out in Section 13.3 Examination and Assessment Regulations published each year in the Student Handbook.

Week 1 Beginning: 12 January 2026

Description of Work Completed:

During this week, the project proposal was completed and submitted. Following initial feedback, the project focus was refined from a general interactive animation concept to a more practical character-based short animation format.

Research was conducted into short-form 2D character animation for social media platforms, including TikTok and Instagram Reels. The project concept was clarified to focus on a single recurring original character and short animated clips of 10–15 seconds in duration.

Initial planning work began, including defining the target platform, animation format, tools, and overall project scope. The project diary was set up, and preparation for the Planning & Research document commenced.

Notes (and things to remember):

Confirm project direction and scope with supervisor.
Continue research into character-based animation styles.
Begin detailed Planning & Research document.
Start documenting character design and animation ideas.

Signed (and dated): 12.01.2026

_____C00301432_____ _____

Student **Supervisor**

Week 2 Beginning: 19 January 2026

Description of Work Completed:

During this week, further research was carried out into short-form 2D character animation, with a focus on content created for social media platforms such as TikTok and Instagram Reels. Particular attention was given to timing, pacing, and emotional storytelling within a 10–15 second duration.

The Planning & Research document was developed in more detail, including defining the project structure, platform choice, and software workflow. The overall scope of the project was clarified to focus on a small series of short character-based animations rather than a single long piece.

Initial work began on documenting the main character, including considering personality traits, emotional range, and animation style. Early ideas for short animation scenarios were also outlined.

Notes (and things to remember):

Continue development of character design and visual style.
Finalise character description for documentation.
Select 3–5 animation scenarios for storyboarding.
Prepare material for supervisor feedback.

Signed (and dated): 19/01/2026

_____C00301432_____ _____

Student **Supervisor**

Week 3 Beginning: 26 January 2026

Description of Work Completed:

During this week, the focus of the project was on character development. The design of the main 2D character was finalised, including overall style, proportions, and visual consistency. The character was developed with a simple and readable design suitable for short-form animation and mobile viewing.

Character assets were prepared for animation, with key body parts separated into layers to support efficient animation in After Effects. Consideration was given to how the character's design supports expressive movement and emotional storytelling.

The character's personality and emotional range were further defined, focusing on subtle everyday emotions such as calmness, waiting, loneliness, and quiet happiness. This work supports the narrative direction of the project and prepares the foundation for storyboarding and animation in subsequent weeks.

Notes (and things to remember):

Begin selecting specific animation scenarios for storyboarding.
Start planning short scenes based on the character's emotional range.
Ensure character assets are fully prepared for animation.
Prepare material for supervisor feedback if required.

Signed (and dated): 26/01/2026

_____C00301432_____ _____

Student **Supervisor**

Week 4 Beginning: 02 February 2026

Description of Work Completed:

During this week I continued developing the concept for my animation project titled Short Character Stories for Social Platforms.

I refined the core idea of the project, which focuses on short animated moments featuring a recurring character designed for vertical social media formats such as TikTok and Instagram Reels.

I created a mind map to explore possible narrative directions, emotional tones, and storytelling approaches for the character. This helped structure the project and identify several possible short story concepts.

Following this, I produced a series of thumbnail sketches to explore visual storytelling and scene composition. These quick sketches allowed me to test different narrative ideas and emotional beats for the character.

From these initial ideas I selected three final scene concepts that will form the basis of the project animations:

Morning Scene – the character drinking from a cup in a calm morning moment.
Approach Scene – the character walking from the background toward the viewer, interacting briefly before leaving the frame.
Reading Scene – the character reading a book and becoming emotional, ending with a single tear.
I also began organising my project documentation for Deliverable 2, including the project objectives, creative concept, themes, emotional tone, and technical considerations.

Notes (and things to remember):

Continue developing visual materials for the project, including additional thumbnail sketches and early storyboard planning for the remaining scenes.
Prepare visual references and refine the character animation approach for After Effects, including facial expression changes and subtle motion.
Next steps include beginning more detailed storyboards and planning the animation workflow for the three scenes.

Signed (and dated): 02/02/2026

_____C00301432_____ _____

Student **Supervisor**

Week 5 Beginning: 09 February 2026

Description of Work Completed:

During this week I continued developing the pre-production stage of my animation project Short Character Stories for Social Platforms.

Building on the concepts selected in the previous week, I began developing the visual planning for the three short animation scenes. I worked on refining the narrative structure of each scene to ensure that the emotional moments are clear and readable within a short duration suitable for social media platforms.

I started creating storyboard panels to visualise the key actions and expressions of the character in each scene. These storyboards help define the timing, character poses, and camera framing before beginning the animation process.

I also reviewed the character design layers prepared in Photoshop to ensure they are suitable for animation in After Effects. This includes organising facial elements such as eyes and mouth variations, which will allow simple expression changes during animation.

Additionally, I began planning the animation approach for specific scenes, particularly the sequence where the character walks toward the viewer and exits the frame. This scene requires careful use of scale and positioning to create the illusion of depth in a 2D environment.

Notes (and things to remember):

Continue developing detailed storyboards for all three scenes.
Prepare animation-ready character layers and organise assets for import into After Effects.
Test simple animation movements such as facial expressions, scale changes, and subtle character gestures to determine the most effective techniques for the final animations.

Signed (and dated): 09/02/2026

_____C00301432_____ _____

Student **Supervisor**

Week 6 Beginning: 23 February 2026

Description of Work Completed:

During this week I continued the pre-production development of my animation project Short Character Stories for Social Platforms.

I focused on refining the storyboards for the three selected scenes to clarify the visual storytelling and character performance. This process helped define the key poses, character expressions, and transitions between actions in each scene.

I also began planning the timing and pacing of the animations, considering the short duration required for social media formats. The scenes are designed to communicate clear emotional moments within approximately 10–15 seconds each.

Additionally, I started testing simple animation techniques in After Effects. These tests included experimenting with character scale changes to simulate depth, switching facial expressions using layered artwork, and planning how to animate subtle emotional details such as blinking and the tear movement in the third scene.

This experimentation helped confirm that the planned animation techniques are achievable within the available production time.

Notes (and things to remember):

Next steps will focus on preparing the character artwork and scene assets for animation production.
It will also be important to organise the project files and layers carefully to ensure an efficient workflow in After Effects.
Further work will include creating animatic timing tests and beginning the first animation passes for the scenes.

Signed (and dated): 23/02/2026

_____C00301432_____ _____

Student **Supervisor**

Week 7 Beginning: 02 March 2026

Description of Work Completed:

During this week I began the production phase of my animation project Short Character Stories for Social Platforms.

I focused on preparing the character and scene assets for animation in After Effects. The character artwork created in Photoshop was organised into separate layers to allow easier animation control. This included separating elements such as eyes, mouth variations, arms, and hands.

I also imported the character assets into After Effects and began setting up the main composition in a vertical 9:16 format suitable for social media platforms. This stage involved testing how the character elements behave when animated and ensuring the layers are correctly positioned.

Initial animation work was started on the first scene (Morning). This included simple character movement such as holding the cup, subtle body motion, and facial expression changes.

Additionally, I began organising all project assets and files into a clear folder structure to support an efficient production workflow.

Notes (and things to remember):

Continue developing animation for Scene 1 and begin preparing assets for Scene 2.
Pay attention to subtle motion details such as blinking, breathing movement, and character timing to enhance emotional expression.
Ensure all artwork layers remain well organised to avoid technical issues during animation.

Asset List
Character Assets
Main character body
Character head
Eyes (open)
Eyes (closed / blinking)
Mouth (smile)
Mouth (neutral)
Arms
Hands
Cup prop
Book prop
Tear element (for Scene 3)

Background Assets
Kitchen background (Scene 1)
Neutral room background (Scene 3)
Simple background for approach scene (Scene 2)

Animation Elements
Character scale animation (depth illusion)
Facial expression switching
Blinking animation
Tear animation
Subtle body motion

Technical Assets
After Effects project file
Photoshop layered character file
Scene compositions (9:16 format)
Export settings for social media video

Signed (and dated): 02/03/2026

_____C00301432_____ _____

Student **Supervisor**

Week 8 Beginning: 09 March 2026

Description of Work Completed:

During this week I continued the production stage of my animation project Short Character Stories for Social Platforms.

I focused on developing the animation for the second scene, where the character approaches the viewer from the background and then leaves the frame. This required experimenting with scale and positioning to simulate depth within a 2D environment. By gradually increasing and decreasing the character's size, I created the illusion that the character is moving through space.

I also refined the animation of Scene 1 by adjusting the timing and subtle character movements. Small details such as facial expressions and hand movement were improved to make the animation feel more natural and expressive.

Additionally, I began preparing elements for Scene 3, which involves the character reading a book and expressing a quiet emotional moment. I tested how the tear animation could be implemented and planned the facial expression changes needed for this scene.

This stage helped progress the project further into the production phase and clarified the animation workflow for the remaining work.

Notes (and things to remember):

Continue working on Scene 3 animation and refine character expressions to clearly communicate emotion.
Focus on smooth timing, subtle movements, and consistent animation style across all three scenes.
Prepare for the polishing stage, including refining motion, adjusting timing, and preparing the animations for final export.

Signed (and dated): 09/03/2026

_____C00301432_____ _____

Student **Supervisor**

Week 9 Beginning: 16 March 2026

Description of Work Completed:

During this week I continued developing my animation project Short Character Stories for Social Platforms and expanded the project presentation by creating a website to showcase the animations.

I completed further animation work on the project scenes and refined character expressions and timing to improve emotional clarity. Particular attention was given to subtle details such as facial movement and overall animation flow.

In addition to the animation work, I designed and created a simple website where the animated videos can be presented as a small collection of short character stories. The website acts as an online platform for displaying the final animations and allows viewers to easily watch the videos in one place.

The videos were exported from After Effects and uploaded to the website. The layout of the site was organised to present the project clearly, including the project title and the three short animated scenes.

Creating the website helped extend the project beyond animation production and demonstrates how the content could be presented on an online platform.

Notes (and things to remember):

Continue refining the animations and prepare the final versions for presentation.
Review the website layout and ensure all videos play correctly and are presented clearly.
Begin preparing final documentation and presentation materials for the project submission.

Website Description

As part of the project presentation, I created a simple website to showcase the animated short stories developed during the project.

The website acts as an online gallery where viewers can watch the animations directly in the browser. The structure of the website is intentionally simple and clear, allowing the videos to be the main focus of the page.

The homepage contains a title section introducing the project, followed by a gallery layout where the animated videos are displayed. Each animation is presented inside a card that includes a video player, a short title, and a brief description.

The videos are embedded using HTML5 video elements, allowing users to play the animations directly without needing to download any files. This approach makes the website accessible across different devices and browsers.

The website demonstrates how the animated content can be presented on a digital platform and provides a simple portfolio-style presentation for the project.

Signed (and dated): 16/03/2026

_____C00301432_____ _____

Student **Supervisor**

Week 10 Beginning: 23 March 2026

Description of Work Completed:

During this week I continued refining my animation project Short Character Stories for Social Platforms and focused on final improvements to both the animated content and the online presentation.

I reviewed the animated scenes and made adjustments to timing, movement, and overall visual consistency. This included improving small character actions such as facial expressions, subtle body movement, and transitions between key poses to make the animations feel smoother and more natural.

I also continued developing the project website, ensuring that the animated videos were clearly presented and easy to access. The structure and layout of the website were reviewed to improve the overall presentation of the project as a small online portfolio.

In addition, I reviewed the project materials created so far, including storyboard planning, animation tests, and scene development, in order to prepare for final project submission and presentation.

This stage helped bring the project closer to completion and allowed me to focus on polish and presentation quality.

Notes (and things to remember):

Continue preparing the final version of the animations and ensure all exported videos are organised correctly.
Review the website and make any final improvements to layout, titles, and video presentation.
Begin final preparation for submission, including documentation, reports, and project presentation materials.

Signed (and dated): 23/03/2026

_____C00301432_____ _____

Student **Supervisor**

Week 11 Beginning: 13 April 2026

Description of Work Completed:

During this week I finalised my animation project Short Character Stories for Social Platforms and completed all remaining work in preparation for submission.

I reviewed and refined the final versions of all animated scenes to ensure consistency in timing, movement, and visual quality. Minor adjustments were made to improve smoothness and clarity of character actions and expressions.

All animations were exported in the required format and prepared for presentation. I ensured that the videos were optimised for playback and suitable for display on digital platforms.

I also finalised the project website, making sure that all videos were correctly uploaded and presented in a clear and accessible layout. The website now functions as a simple online portfolio showcasing the animated series.

In addition, I completed the project documentation, including reports, planning materials, and supporting content required for submission.

This week focused on bringing all elements of the project together and ensuring that the final outcome is complete, organised, and ready for assessment.

Notes (and things to remember):

Ensure all required files are submitted correctly, including videos, documentation, and website links.
Double-check that all materials meet the submission requirements and are properly formatted.
Reflect on the project process and identify key learning outcomes for the final report.

Signed (and dated): 13/04/2026

_____C00301432_____ _____

Student **Supervisor**

Week 12 Beginning: 20 April 2026

Description of Work Completed:

During this final week I completed the submission process for my project Short Character Stories for Social Platforms.

All required materials, including the animated videos, website link, and project documentation, were reviewed and submitted through the appropriate platforms. I ensured that all files were correctly formatted and accessible.

I carried out a final check of the animations and the website to confirm that everything was functioning as expected and presented clearly. This included reviewing video playback, layout, and overall project presentation.

In addition to submission, I reflected on the overall project process, including the development stages from initial concept to final production. This reflection helped identify key areas of learning, particularly in character animation, timing, and workflow organisation.

This week marks the completion of the project, bringing together all creative and technical elements into a final, cohesive outcome.

Notes (and things to remember):

Ensure all submitted materials remain accessible (especially website links and video files).
Prepare for potential feedback and evaluation from supervisors.
Reflect on strengths and areas for improvement for future projects.

Signed (and dated): 20/04/2026

_____C00301432_____ _____

Student **Supervisor**

Extra Notes :

Throughout this project I developed a range of technical and creative skills in 2D animation and visual storytelling.

I improved my understanding of character animation, particularly in creating subtle emotional expressions using minimal movement. I also learned how to prepare character artwork for animation by separating it into layers and organising assets effectively.

Working with After Effects helped me understand timing, pacing, and how to create simple but expressive animations suitable for short-form content.

I also gained experience in presenting digital work through a website, which extended the project beyond animation and into online content presentation.

One of the key challenges was balancing simplicity with expressive storytelling, especially within a very short duration. However, this helped me focus on clarity and intentional design.

Overall, the project helped me develop both technical animation skills and a better understanding of how to create engaging digital content for modern platforms.